

Think-Aloud transcript 2

So, whatever we're going to do in the prototype test, whatever you're going to click on or maybe see, that's all okay, nothing is right or wrong. I just want to know what you think. So it's really about what you think of the functionality, what feels vague or what feels clear, maybe unnecessary or something that is missing. It's not fully functional, so what I'm going to have to do is, if you want to click on something, then you should just let me know and I'll click for you. So, I'll share my screen. I'll let you kind of do some basic tasks. I'm going to do the clicking. I'm going to ask you to think about what you want to click on and then I'm going to do that for you. So, I'm going to start right away. Let me share my screen.

All right.

And you should be able to see this now. Okay.

Yes.

Can you clearly see it?

I can see it, yeah.

All right. So, first of all, without interacting yet, what do you think you might be able to use this platform for if it were to exist?

It looks like a kind of journaling thing.

Yes.

Okay. Looking at it. Yeah. So, like... Recordings. I guess they're kind of like... I'm assuming, but... Like, maybe you record your thoughts or someone else's thoughts and then you can compile them into, like, a specific category, maybe? I don't know. I think... I mean, you could...

So, what's basically the idea for if it were to exist is that it's basically something where you can upload recordings. You can categorize them, as you said. So, I mean, the recording could, of course, be thoughts. And then there's, like, a diary element to it as well. So, you can add diary entries, maybe, to recordings you have, to albums you have. Kind of recording those thoughts. And if you were to navigate now to find a specific recording, so, for example, in a moment of homesickness, where would you navigate to now?

Well, I suppose on the top tab there's already recordings. Otherwise, I would search playlist, but... Yes.

Yes. So, for recordings you can find specific ones here. You could have also gone through playlists and then, well, maybe click a specific playlist. But, yeah, through recordings you can get there. And right now, what do you think of the things you see on the screen?

Well, like, my first thought was, like, yeah, it's nice to have... Yeah, it's nice to have these things. I also wonder if other people can add to these recordings. It's, like, so that they can, like, share, like... Without me having to record it myself, like, they can share, like, what they want to say to me. And then I would be able to save it there. They... Yeah, there's, like, these tags as well. So, it's, like, easy to navigate or easier to navigate. If there's a lot of recordings, they added. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah.

And do you think that just by looking at this now and just for a couple minutes that you've seen this, that there's anything that you think is missing, maybe, in the recording page? If you can think of anything.

Yeah. Currently, nothing comes to mind. Maybe the option to... Well, I don't know if it would be anywhere else, but maybe the option to swap the, I guess, profile pictures of the recordings, but, like, maybe photos of the person who I would relate to that with more, maybe?

Yes. Yeah, I understand. So, right now, that's good that you say that, because I kind of use just standard stock images. You could... If you were to upload a recording, you could actually upload a PNG or maybe a JPEG. If it were to be functional, that would be the idea, yes. And is there anything that kind of stands out on this page that does seem the most useful?

Um... The most useful... Well, I suppose the tags, but at the same time, you also have, like, the pictures themselves, so you can already kind of assume, okay, like, this one's going to be for that. Um... And then maybe, yeah, the date added, or, like, being able to, um... Organize the recordings based on, you know... You know, I was pretty sure, I... They're alphabetically, chronologically, or by any other means. Um... Yeah. It just makes a better overview and, like... Yeah. To be able to find the recording you need, so...

Yeah. Okay. And now, just because not everything is functional, I only made the first recording clickable, so... you can only click on that. You're going to be in a different page, which is kind of a diary overview page.

Mm-hmm.

So, imagine you have selected a voice recording that would help you cope with homesickness. Um... Could be this one, but I understand if it's not. Um... So, what do you think of the options that you see here? Do you think it's useful? Do you think you would actually use it, maybe, or try it? Um... Or is there anything unclear or redundant?

Um... It doesn't feel very redundant at all. I like... I kind of like the style, like, how it's meant to look, like, in, like, in a journal. It's just, like... It's like having a... I don't know... Like an iPod on a... On your own journal, and you can just, like, save it there. But... Um... Redundancy? I mean... I guess maybe the... On the note, you already have, like, a previous and next. I'm not sure why they would be there. Um... If you could just do a new reflection. And then you also have new pages anyways at the very bottom. Yeah. Um... I mean, that's my only... My only thing, really. But... Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Um...

And do you think you could see yourself actually using such, like, a diary or a reflection type of combination?

Yeah, I'd be... I'd definitely be interested to try it. I do journal a little. Um... Yeah. So... Something like this would be, like, quite interesting. Um... But I think... The one thing... The one aspect that... Would make it a bit different. Like, the journaling I do is, like, physical. So it has its own kind of, like, niche. You know, like, you're doing something. You're... You're being away from the devices, right? And then here, like, you kind of have to be, like, on the device. And you have to actually, like, engage, um... Digitally to save the recordings. But, I mean... How else are you going to do it? Like, how else are you going to save the voice memos? So... Um... I think... I think it's worth trying. You know? Yeah. It's something different.

Okay. Yeah. And... Let me see. Yeah. So... Um... Now you can imagine having listened to this voice recording. Um... And wanting to interact with the diary. Maybe make a new entry. Could you share how you think you would use this system now? What you would click on? Maybe what your thoughts are? Uh... Do you think there's valuable options here? Or maybe something... Um... Something missing?

Um... I would say... I mean, if I want to make a new note, I'd probably go to New Reflection. Click on that and write, like... Something that may come up in my mind. Yeah. Another thing... Uh... Well, I guess... The option to maybe draw? Or, like, sketch? Okay. Kind of? Yeah, that would be... To make, like, a very basic sketch. You know? Uh... All right. Or maybe even... Maybe... An option to add photos as well? Or stickers? Well... For... Stickers... In the form of photos. Like, let's say... Um... I don't know... Um... Like, I... You know, I have this voice recording of my mom. And then I... It reminds me of a... Photo I have of me and my mom. Yeah. And I'll probably want to add it onto this page then. Yeah, exactly. Um... Yeah, so... Would you think then it's... It's more of, like, a... Like a real journal? In which you can, of course, just write

anything you want. Or draw anything you want. Add photos as well. So it would be nice to add that.

Yeah, okay. Um... Let me see. So what I basically want to ask you is... To just let me know if you want to see any more screens. I can show you what it kind of has going on right now. Um... There are a lot of options that you cannot click on. I'll tell you when we get there. If you just want to continue, that's fine as well.

But there's a search bar that I didn't see prior. Uh... I think that would be the most useful one then, actually. Because I tend to use that a lot when I'm... Going through my files or stuff like that, so.. to go back on the previous question .. Um... anything else..

You kind of... Broke up there.

Oh, sorry. I would want to click through the tabs. Okay. But, um... Yeah, let me just have a look. I mean... Most played... Okay. Here you have different categories as well. So, like, two... Organize things from, for example. Most played is, I think, quite nice. Because then you can see, like... Maybe you could compare it with friends as well. Like, okay, what's your most played? Yeah. I like playlists. Um... Upload recording? Let's see. Okay. So, first is sound, creation date. I like the story behind it.

Yeah. And, um... To ask you... Um... Would you have an idea where you could find the story now? Imagine that you have uploaded the recording.

Um... Well, right now, off the top of my head, like... When we were looking at the diary entry from, like... Mom going home about shopping. Um... I would imagine it being next to the... Or, like, above the... The play bar? Like, the... Yeah, here. This is where I would imagine it being.

Okay. So then, at least that makes sense that it's there for you.

Mm-hmm.

All right. Yes.

Okay. And then, create playlist...

That's actually... So that would, once again... You could upload an image. Um...

Mm-hmm. Mm-hmm.

Yeah.

Okay. So... I see there's, like, a settings bar in the top right corner.

Yeah. It's kind of non-functional right now.

Oh, okay, okay.

There's some things that would require more development.

Okay.

Yeah. So, basically, just in general... Do you think there are specific elements that would seem the most useful for you? Or that you would use, maybe, in moments for trying to cope with homesickness? Or things that could still be added that would make it more valuable for you?

Um... Sorry, the first part I didn't hear?

If there are specific elements that you think currently already exist in this prototype, that you think would be helpful when you wanted to cope with homesickness, or at least use this product.

Okay. Um... The elements... The elements... I think... I think just, like, the option to use recordings and implement them into a kind of journal is quite nice. Or the homesickness. Um... I mean, other than that, I mean... Right now, the interface doesn't feel like as if it could only be used for homesickness. I feel like people could also use this for some other stuff, like maybe, like, brainstorming. But using recordings or, like, for music, for example. So I feel like... It may not already be clear that this is, like, just something for homesickness.

Yeah.

That said, it's definitely... I definitely think it could be useful for that. Um... Um... What would I add if I could, if I wanted something different? I mean... Um... I think it would be nice to... If it was something like an online platform, which everyone could, like... Where people can publicize, like, their thoughts or, you know, their feelings of homesickness, I think that would be super helpful. Um... Because then you can really relate to other people, and I think that actually helps combat homesickness a bit better as well, because, you know, you're not alone. There's other people who have this very, very similar feeling, or they're going through the exact same thing. And... Yeah. Um... Whether or not you're able to talk with them, or just comment under their post, I mean, that's... You know, either way. I think, just as long as you know, like, that you can see those, like... The feelings that other people are also going through, then... Maybe they can articulate it better than another person could.

Yeah. Yeah.

That's something I would add.

Okay. Yeah. All right. Yeah. Thank you. Um... I'm gonna just stop sharing my screen. Uh... Yeah, that was it already. Yeah. Thank you so much once again.

No worries.

I really, really appreciate it. All right. Um... Okay. Yeah. Anything else you want to add? Do I want to add anything else?

Um... I mean, just a question. Like, uh... So... Is this, like, for... I'm curious if you're, like, developing a website, or if you're more just exploring just homesickness on its own?

Um... So... Kind of when I started out, it was more to follow up on prototypes that were already developed and kind of make a fully functional one, or basically a website or an app. Yeah. And then along the way, it shifted more into more exploratory while keeping this prototype and adjusting it. So I was still going to see if the prototype is kind of useful if it were to be developed and how. And just kind of thinking what aspects do people think home relate to the personalness, meaningfulness. And then just how we could integrate it into a prototype. And if people would actually think it's useful for, well, maybe alleviation of homesickness and that type of stuff. Yeah. Yeah.